Joseph R. Seitz

First-Year Engineering Student ♦ Student Pilot
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OBJECTIVE

Honors first-year engineering student and student pilot at Purdue pursuing a BS in Aeronautical Engineering with a minor in Sustainable Engineering, seeking research and internship/co-op experience where I can apply analytical, technical, and collaborative skills and grow toward a career in aviation and aerospace.

EDUCATION

Purdue University *(2026 - Present)*
Anticipating Bachelor of Science, Aeronautical & Astronautical Engineering | Minor: Sustainable Engineering
- John Martinson Honors College
- Expected graduation: May 2030

Zionsville Community High School *(2022 - 2026)*
Academic Honors Diploma • Magna Cum Laude • GPA 4.3

Student Pilot with Purdue Aviation & Jet Access Flight Training
- 40 flight hours toward Private Pilot License

WORK EXPERIENCE

STAR Bank Performing Arts Center & Zionsville Community Schools — Technical Crew *(2024 - Present)*
- Supporting Zionsville Community Schools events and productions across live event operations
- Facilitating district-wide equipment management, assisting with event setup, teardown, and logistics to ensure events run smoothly
- Coordinating with event staff and student teams to run audio, lighting, and video for productions ranging from small assemblies to 4,000-seat commencement ceremonies
- Contributing to large-scale events at ZCHS, including yearly commencement and homecoming

Private Piano Instructor *(2024 - 2026)*
- Built individualized lesson plans for up to 8 students (ages 5–16); retained students across multiple years to graded milestones and recitals

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

- ZSI Royalaires Show Choir — Bass Section Leader (2024–2026): led vocal work, group earned national recognition for vocal excellence
- ZSI Combo (Show Choir Band) — Instrumentalist & Captain (2023, 2025–2026), group earned national recognition
- Purdue University Dance Marathon — Event Logistics
- Purdue Pilots, Inc.
- Purdue Aviation Research Club - Aviation Technologies Team
- Purdue Jazz Bands — Alto Saxophone
- Discovery English Camp, Granada, Spain — teaching assistant, photography, and videography for Spanish students ages 4–14
- Wheeler Mission Men’s Shelter, Indianapolis, IN — meal preparation and service for individuals experiencing homelessness

HONORS, AWARDS & SKILLS

- **Honors & Awards:** AP Scholar with Distinction (2026), AP Scholar (2025), National Merit Commended Student (2025), ZSI Musicianship Award (2025)
- **Skills & Proficiencies:** Calculus, C Programming, Python Programming, Project Engineering, Flight Training, Flight Mechanics, Technical Operations, Equipment Management, Live Events, Music Performance, Leadership, Mentorship, Communication, Team Collaboration, Organization, Community Outreach

PROJECTS

MACRO Mars Cargo Rover – Purdue University, ENGR 16100 *(Fall 2026 - Present)*
- Designing and building an autonomous Mars cargo rover prototype with a 4-person team in response to a mock RFP; rover follows a broken guideline, crosses rough terrain, avoids moving obstacles, and delivers cargo to one of three sites and back
- Developed the system's functional block diagram, mapping sensing, control, locomotion, cargo handling, and power functions for the design specification report

FYE Catapult Design Project – Purdue University, ENGR 16100 *(Sep 2026)*
- Collaborated with a 4-person team to design and build a catapult, optimizing for distance, accuracy, minimum weight, and minimum material cost under strict build constraints